

Amazon Echo Dot (5th Gen, 2023 release)

Adequate for the price

Amazon has had a stronghold in the smart devices market with their Echo line of products. The latest in their line of Echo smart speakers, powered by their homegrown assistant Alexa is the Amazon Echo Dot (5th Gen, 2023). With the upgrades in both the hardware and software, it did surprise many folks who played around with it, feeding it some really interesting and challenging commands. Here's a look at how the Amazon Echo Dot (5th Gen, 2023 release) fared in our tests –

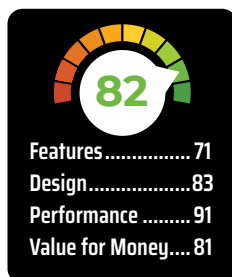


BUILD AND DESIGN

Amazon has definitely worked on the design of the Echo Dot (5th Gen, 2023 release). Coming in line with the rest of the lineup, it comes with a fabric-covered top, with solid and sturdy plastic completing the rest of the body. There's a nice heft to the device, and the feet do a good job of keeping it from slipping, even when it is placed on smooth glass-finish surfaces. The indicator LED strip covers the bottom circumference of the device. On the body of the speaker itself, you get a set of four buttons that'll help you control the device without using voice commands for the most part. The top surface of the speaker is touch sensitive. On the front, you get a set of basic LEDs that will get you some basic information, including but not limited to time and temperature readings. As for the app, the Amazon Alexa app offers tons of customisation options, including privacy settings and an equaliser. It is laden with features, with the interface being intuitive.

FEATURES

Amazon has added a couple of sensors,



which immensely elevate the functionality of this product. First off, is the motion sensor. If your Amazon Echo Dot is plugged in and turned on, it will automatically trigger a set action as soon as it senses motion. And it works the other way around as well.

The second is the temperature sensor. Its functionality is very basic. When in action, the sensor will gauge the ambient temperature and adjust the temperature of your air conditioner accordingly, helping you have an uninterrupted night's sleep. Other features of the Echo Dot include compatibility with a variety of music providers. You can also daisy chain the Alexa with other Bluetooth devices as well, creating a wireless stereo setup with up to two speakers and a subwoofer. The device can also be used as a stand-alone Bluetooth speaker as well.

PERFORMANCE

In my time listening to music on this device, I found the sound to be great for regular music consumption. With the readings taken in an environment where such devices are used the most, an open room, both the bass frequencies

(especially the high bass frequencies, which trickle into the mids) and the high frequencies between the 2 kHz and the 10 kHz range have a boost, with the mids staying close to our baseline reading of the pink noise. This shows that the sound is well-rounded, and you will not be busy hunting for vocals or instruments in your favourite tracks. Considering their use case, the Amazon Echo Dot 5th Gen will serve their owner well. We played a variety of tracks on this device, and sometimes we did feel the lack of some bass, which is strange because Amazon has specifically advertised the bass response of this speaker. Now, coming to the smart voice command capabilities of this device. In all our test scenarios, the device performed well. I tested the activation time between the command being said and actions being triggered, and almost every time, the response was instantaneous and flawless.

VERDICT

The Amazon Echo Dot (5th Gen, 2023 release) is one of the best mini smart speakers to get your hands on. Priced at ₹5,499, it has all the features that you could ask for, and the responsiveness is something that would put other manufacturers to shame. The only other viable option in this space right now, is the Google Nest Mini. In India, it retails at almost half the price of the Echo Dot (₹2,499 at the time of writing). It retains most of the functionality of its pricier cousins but pales in comparison to the Echo Dot in terms of its audio output because of its smaller size. The 3rd Gen Amazon Echo Dot, for the price, is a great offering and can be an awesome gateway for anyone into the world of smart home speakers.

–Satvik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

Size: 3.9" x 3.9" x 3.5" | Weight: approx. 304 gm
 | Audio: 44 mm front-firing speaker, Lossless High Definition | Wifi connectivity: Dual-band Wi-Fi supports 802.11a/b/g/n/ac (2.4 and 5 GHz) networks. | Bluetooth connectivity: Advanced Audio Distribution Profile (A2DP) support

CONTACT

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